

SilverShield Insurance

Master Policy Document

Policy Effective Date: January 1, 2024

Document Version: 3.2

Applicable Plans: Silver PPO 3000, Gold HMO 1500, Platinum PPO 500

Table of Contents

Section 1: Definitions and Key Terms	2
Section 2: Coverage Overview	2
Section 3: Network and Provider Requirements	3
Section 4: Covered Perils and Services	3
Section 5: Prior Authorization Requirements	4
Section 6: Cost Sharing and Deductibles	4
Section 7: Exclusions and Limitations	5
Section 8: Claims Filing Procedures	5
Section 9: Appeals and Grievance Process	6
Section 10: Auto Insurance Provisions	6
Section 11: Homeowners Insurance Provisions	7
Section 12: Travel Insurance Provisions	7

Section 1 - Definitions & Key Terms

The following terms have specific meanings throughout this policy document. Understanding these definitions is essential to interpreting your coverage.

Deductible:	The amount you must pay out-of-pocket for covered services before the insurance plan begins to pay. For the Silver PPO 3000 plan, the annual deductible is \$3,000 for individuals and \$6,000 for families.
Coinsurance:	Your share of costs after you have met your deductible. Typically 20% for in-network services and 40% for out-of-network services.
Copayment:	A fixed dollar amount you pay for a covered service at the time of receiving care. Primary care visits: \$30; Specialist visits: \$50; Emergency room: \$250.
Out-of-Pocket Maximum:	The most you will pay during a policy year before the plan covers 100% of allowed charges. Individual: \$8,150; Family: \$16,300.
In-Network Provider:	A healthcare provider who has a contract with SilverShield Insurance to provide services at pre-negotiated rates.
Out-of-Network Provider:	A healthcare provider who does not have a contract with SilverShield Insurance. Services from these providers may not be covered or may be covered at a reduced rate.
Prior Authorization:	Approval that SilverShield Insurance requires before you receive certain services or medications. Failure to obtain prior authorization may result in denial of the claim.
Allowed Amount:	The maximum amount SilverShield will recognize for a covered service. Also called 'eligible expense' or 'negotiated rate.'
Explanation of Benefits (EOB):	statement from SilverShield that explains what was covered for a medical service, what the insurer paid, and what the member owes.
Network Gap Exception:	A special provision allowing coverage of out-of-network services at in-network rates when no in-network provider is available within 50 miles of the member's residence.

Section 2 - Coverage Overview

SilverShield Insurance provides comprehensive coverage across multiple insurance lines including health, auto, homeowners, life, and travel insurance. Each policy type has specific terms and conditions detailed in subsequent sections.

2.1 Health Insurance Plans

Three health plan tiers are available:

- Silver PPO 3000: \$3,000 deductible, 80/20 coinsurance, broad network
- Gold HMO 1500: \$1,500 deductible, 90/10 coinsurance, HMO network
- Platinum PPO 500: \$500 deductible, 95/5 coinsurance, broadest network

All plans cover preventive care at 100% with no deductible when using in-network providers.

2.2 Multi-Line Discount

Members who hold two or more SilverShield policies (e.g., health + auto, or home + auto) qualify for a 10% multi-line

discount on all premiums.

Section 3 - Network & Provider Requirements

3.1 In-Network Provider Usage

All non-emergency services must be obtained from in-network providers to receive full coverage benefits. Using an in-network provider ensures you pay the lowest out-of-pocket costs. The SilverShield provider directory is updated quarterly and available at silvershield.example.com/providers.

3.2 Out-of-Network Services

Services from out-of-network providers are generally not covered under HMO plans. Under PPO plans, out-of-network services are covered at a reduced rate (60% vs 80% after deductible). The member is responsible for any charges exceeding the allowed amount. Balance billing protections apply in states where mandated.

3.3 Network Gap Exceptions

If no in-network provider for a required specialty or service is available within 50 miles of the member's primary residence, SilverShield will authorize coverage of an out-of-network provider at in-network rates. Members must call 1-800-555-0199 to request a network gap exception before receiving services. Approved exceptions are valid for 90 days and may be renewed.

3.4 Emergency Services Exception

Emergency room visits are covered at in-network rates regardless of the facility's network status. An emergency is defined as a medical condition manifesting itself by acute symptoms of sufficient severity (including severe pain) such that a prudent layperson could reasonably expect that the absence of immediate medical attention would place their health in serious jeopardy.

Section 4 - Covered Perils & Services

4.1 Health - Covered Services

Covered health services include: preventive care, diagnostic imaging, laboratory services, inpatient and outpatient surgery, maternity care, mental health services, prescription drugs (formulary), rehabilitation services, and durable medical equipment. All services are subject to applicable deductibles, coinsurance, and prior authorization.

4.2 Home - Covered Perils

Standard homeowners coverage includes protection against: fire and lightning, windstorm and hail, explosion, riot, aircraft and vehicle damage, smoke, vandalism, theft, volcanic eruption, falling objects, weight of ice/snow/sleet, accidental discharge of water or steam from household systems, sudden tearing/cracking/bulging of heating/cooling/plumbing systems, freezing of plumbing, and sudden accidental damage from artificially generated electrical current.

Section 5 - Prior Authorization Requirements

5.1 Services Requiring Authorization

The following services require prior authorization:

- Advanced diagnostic imaging (MRI, CT scan, PET scan)
- Specialty referrals (non-primary care physicians)
- Elective inpatient procedures and surgeries
- Outpatient surgical procedures
- Durable medical equipment over \$500
- Home health services
- Physical, occupational, and speech therapy beyond 20 visits/year
- Prescription medications on the specialty tier

Prior authorization requests must be submitted at least 5 business days before the scheduled service date. Urgent requests are processed within 72 hours.

5.2 Authorization Process

To obtain prior authorization: (1) Your physician submits a request to SilverShield including clinical justification. (2) SilverShield's medical review team evaluates the request within 5 business days. (3) You and your physician receive written notification of approval or denial. (4) Approved authorizations are valid for 60 days from the approval date.

5.3 Consequences of Missing Authorization

Claims for services that required but did not receive prior authorization may be denied in full. The member is responsible for the entire cost. Retroactive authorization may be granted in emergency situations within 48 hours of service.

Section 6 - Cost Sharing & Deductibles

6.1 Annual Deductible

The annual deductible resets on January 1 of each plan year. All covered services (except preventive care) count toward the deductible. Once the deductible is met, the plan pays its share (coinsurance) for covered services.

Silver PPO 3000: \$3,000 individual / \$6,000 family

Gold HMO 1500: \$1,500 individual / \$3,000 family

Platinum PPO 500: \$500 individual / \$1,000 family

6.2 Coinsurance After Deductible

After meeting the deductible, you pay coinsurance (your percentage of costs) until you reach the out-of-pocket maximum. In-network coinsurance: 20% (Silver), 10% (Gold), 5% (Platinum). Out-of-network coinsurance: 40% (Silver/Platinum PPO). HMO plans do not cover out-of-network services except emergencies.

Section 7 - Exclusions & Limitations

7.1 General Exclusions

The following are NOT covered under any SilverShield policy:

- Cosmetic surgery (unless medically necessary for reconstruction)
- Experimental or investigational treatments
- Services received outside the United States (except Travel policy)
- Workers' compensation claims
- Self-inflicted injuries
- Services not medically necessary as determined by SilverShield
- Long-term custodial care

7.2 Homeowners Exclusions

Standard homeowners policies exclude: flood damage, earthquake damage, normal wear and tear, gradual deterioration, pest/insect/rodent damage, mold from long-term moisture, neglect or intentional damage, government action, nuclear hazard, and power failure originating outside the premises. Flood and earthquake endorsements are available for additional premium.

7.3 Auto Exclusions

Auto insurance excludes: intentional damage, racing or speed contests, use of vehicle for hire (without commercial endorsement), mechanical breakdown, wear and tear, damage while used for illegal purposes, and damage to custom parts/equipment not declared on the policy.

Section 8 - Claims Filing Procedures

8.1 Filing a Claim

Claims can be filed online at silvershield.example.com/claims, by calling 1-800-555-0199, or by mailing a completed claim form to SilverShield Insurance, PO Box 12345, Hartford, CT 06101. Health claims from in-network providers are typically filed automatically by the provider.

8.2 Required Documentation

All claims require: completed claim form, proof of loss, itemized bills or receipts, and relevant supporting documentation (police report for theft/accident, physician statement for medical claims, photos for property damage). Incomplete claims will be returned with a request for additional information.

8.3 Claims Processing Timeline

Standard claims are processed within 30 days of receipt of complete documentation. Health claims: typically 15 business days. Auto claims: 10-20 business days depending on investigation requirements. Home claims: 15-30 business days. Expedited processing is available for hardship cases.

Section 9 - Appeals & Grievance Process

9.1 Right to Appeal

You have the right to appeal any claim denial or adverse benefit determination. Appeals must be filed in writing within 180 days of receiving the denial notice. Include your policy number, claim number, explanation of why you disagree with the decision, and any supporting documentation.

9.2 Internal Appeal Process

Level 1 Appeal: Reviewed by a senior claims examiner not involved in the original decision. Response within 30 days for post-service appeals, 15 days for pre-service. Level 2 Appeal: If Level 1 is upheld, a second appeal is reviewed by the Medical Director or designee. Response within 30 days.

9.3 External Review

After exhausting internal appeals, you may request an independent external review by a certified Independent Review Organization (IRO). External review requests must be made within 4 months of the final internal appeal decision. The IRO decision is binding on SilverShield Insurance.

Section 10 - Auto Insurance Provisions

10.1 Collision Coverage

Covers damage to the insured vehicle resulting from collision with another vehicle or object, regardless of fault. Subject to the selected deductible (\$250, \$500, or \$1,000). Does not cover mechanical breakdown, wear, or maintenance.

10.2 Comprehensive Coverage

Covers non-collision damage including theft, vandalism, natural disasters, falling objects, fire, flood, and animal strikes. Subject to the selected deductible.

10.3 Aftermarket Modifications

Custom parts, aftermarket modifications, and non-factory equipment are ONLY covered if specifically declared on the policy with supplemental coverage (Custom Parts and Equipment endorsement). Undeclared modifications are excluded from all coverage. Members must notify SilverShield within 30 days of installing modifications valued over \$1,000.

Section 11 - Homeowners Insurance Provisions

11.1 Dwelling Coverage

Covers the physical structure of your home against covered perils (see Section 4.2). Coverage is at replacement cost, meaning the cost to rebuild with similar materials and quality without deduction for depreciation.

11.2 Water Damage - Covered vs. Excluded

COVERED: Sudden and accidental water damage from burst pipes, failed appliances, accidental overflow, and fire suppression systems. EXCLUDED: Gradual leaks, seepage, condensation, mold from chronic moisture, flood (rising water from external sources), and sewer/drain backup (unless endorsement added). Important: To be covered, water damage must be sudden and accidental, not the result of deferred maintenance or neglect.

11.3 Additional Living Expenses (ALE)

When the home is uninhabitable due to a covered loss, SilverShield covers reasonable costs for temporary housing, meals above normal living expenses, and local transportation. ALE coverage is limited to 20% of dwelling coverage and a maximum duration of 12 months. Receipts are required for all ALE claims.

11.4 Personal Property

Replacement cost coverage for personal belongings damaged or destroyed by a covered peril. Standard limit: 50% of dwelling coverage. Sub-limits apply: jewelry \$1,500, electronics \$2,500, firearms \$2,500, collectibles \$1,000. Higher limits available with scheduled personal property endorsement.

Section 12 - Travel Insurance Provisions

12.1 Trip Cancellation

Covers non-refundable trip costs when cancellation is due to: illness or injury of insured or immediate family member, death in the family, jury duty, natural disaster at destination rendering it uninhabitable, terrorism event at destination within 30 days of departure, involuntary job loss, or military deployment.

12.2 Documentation Requirements

Medical cancellation requires a signed attending physician's statement confirming the condition prevented travel, submitted within 30 days of cancellation. All claims require original receipts, booking confirmations, and proof of non-refundability. Claims must be filed within 90 days of the covered event.

12.3 Trip Interruption

If a trip is cut short due to a covered reason, covers: unused non-refundable expenses on a pro-rata basis, reasonable additional transportation costs to return home (economy class equivalent), and up to \$200/day for additional accommodation if stranded due to a covered event.

Section 13 - Contact Information

SilverShield Insurance Company
PO Box 12345, Hartford, CT 06101

General Inquiries: 1-800-555-0199
Claims Department: 1-800-555-0200
Appeals Department: 1-800-555-0201
Prior Authorization: 1-800-555-0202
Website: silvershield.example.com
Member Portal: my.silvershield.example.com

This policy document is for demonstration purposes. It represents a sample insurance policy used by ClaimClear AI to showcase RAG-grounded explanation generation. SilverShield Insurance is a fictional company.